

AFRICA'S BLUE ECONOMY IN FOCUS

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Africa's Blue Economy Progress and Successes

The blue economy has grown into a major continental development priority in Africa, supported by stronger policies, institutions and regional cooperation. [More than 80% of African countries have incorporated blue economy priorities into national development or climate plans, while 21 countries have adopted dedicated strategies and another 26 are developing them.](#)

The African Union (AU) estimates that Africa's blue economy generates an estimated US\$296–300 billion annually and supports about 49 million jobs, with progress recorded in sustainable financing, fisheries monitoring, marine conservation, ecosystem restoration and transboundary resource management. Initiatives such as blue bonds, digital monitoring systems, the Great Blue Wall and mangrove restoration programmes demonstrate growing blue economy investment in climate resilience and inclusive opportunities for women, youth and coastal communities.

The Luanda Declaration on Blue Economy

On 24th July 2026, AU Member States adopted the Luanda Declaration on the African Blue Economy at the Third Africa Blue Economy Week in Angola – committing to translate the continental blue economy framework into practical national programmes and investment portfolios. The Declaration seeks to position the blue economy as a key driver of the Agenda 2063 by:

- mobilising sustainable public and private finance for port infrastructure, marine transport and offshore renewable energy;
- protecting marine and freshwater ecosystems from pollution, climate change and illegal fishing; and
- using the African Continental Free Trade Area to expand regional trade in fisheries, aquaculture and coastal tourism.

Sustaining Africa's Blue Economy Momentum

The Luanda Declaration provides an important opportunity to build on Africa's blue economy progress by translating continental commitments into well-financed, inclusive national programmes.

Success will depend on sustained political leadership and the meaningful participation of women, youth and coastal communities to turn Africa's blue economy commitments into measurable and lasting benefits for people, economies and ecosystems.

